The Rite of the Hevajra Fire Offering

Hevajrahomavidhi · Toh 1256 · Derge Tengyur

དཀྱེ་པ་རདོ་རྗེའི་སྦྱིན་སྲེག་གཙེ་ཆ་ཞོག

The Rite of the Hevajra Fire Offering, known in Sanskrit as the Hevajrahomavidhi and in Tibetan as Dgyes pa rdo rje'i sbyin sreg gi cho ga, is a short ritual manual in verse explaining how to perform the fire offering, or homa, within the practice of the Hevajra tantra. After paying homage to Hevajra and his consort Nairātmyā, it distinguishes three kinds of fire offering: the unsurpassed, in which the aggregates and the rest are burned as fuel in the fire of wisdom; the inner, which is the eating of food; and the outer, in which substances are offered into a physical fire. It then sets out the outer rite, including the invitation of the fire god and the deities, the offerings and praises suited to the activities of pacifying, increasing, subjugating and fierce action, and the concluding dismissal and dedication of merit. According to its colophon, it was composed by the master Kṛṣṇa and translated into Tibetan by the Indian preceptor Gayādhara together with the translator Gö Lhatsé. It is Toh 1256 in the Tengyur, where it belongs among the commentaries and ritual works on the tantras.

In the language of India: he vajra homa bidhi. In the language of Tibet: The Rite of the Hevajra Fire Offering.

Homage to glorious Hevajra.

Having bowed to glorious Hevajra
and to Nairātmyā,
through the kindness of the vajra master
I shall explain the rite of the fire offering.
You who wish to benefit self and others,
abandon conceptual thought, pride and the like,
and with a mind that follows the Dharma
listen to the rite of the fire offering.
Unsurpassed, inner and outer:
the fire offering is divided into three kinds.
To burn the aggregates and the rest as firewood
in the fire of wisdom is the unsurpassed.
Eating food and the like is called the inner.
The outer is the fire offering of substances to be burnt.
At the preparatory consecration of this maṇḍala

and at the time of accomplishment, perform the fire offering.
Secret mantra that is not recited is not accomplished,
and without the fire offering it yields no fruit.
In order to accomplish all activities fully,
perform the activities of fire offering with diligence.
Pacifying is for destroying wrongdoing;
increasing is for fully multiplying merit;
subjugating is for cultivating passion;
the fierce rite is for slaying conceptual thought.
Because they pacify afflictions and wrongdoing
and increase meditative absorption,
through the yoga of your own deity
you should do with the mind whatever you wish.
Therefore all shall be explained:
the characteristics of the hearths and of the substances,
the practitioner, the deities,
and the means of accomplishment: these five.

Of these, the general method of the fire offering is explained.
The divisions of sentient beings are limitless;
by the divisions of activity they become four,
and by the divisions of family, five.
For pacifying the color is white;
for increasing, the color of gold;
for subjugating the color is red;
for the fierce rite it is black;
for summoning and expelling it is black.
For pacifying the hearth is round;
for increasing make it square;
for the fierce rite it is triangular;
the remaining rites should be accomplished in that one.
One cubit in width and one span in depth
is the hearth for pacifying.
Two cubits in width and one cubit in depth
is the hearth for increasing.
Twenty fingers in width
and ten fingers in depth is for the fierce rite;

for subjugating and summoning it is the same.
For pacifying, a rim of four fingers surrounds it;
for increasing, eight fingers;
for the fierce rite, three fingers;
for subjugating and summoning, likewise.
In the center of the hearth for pacifying
draw a vajra and a curved knife,
and surround the rim too with vajras.
In the hearth for increasing, a jewel,
and surround the rim with jewels.
In the hearth for the fierce rite, a sword,
and surround the rim too with swords.
For subjugating and summoning, a hook,
and surround the rim too with hooks.
All such hearths, moreover,
are anointed with scent of the matching color.
Pacifying is done facing the east;
increasing is done facing the north;
the fierce rite faces the south;
subjugating and summoning face the west.
For pacifying the ground is white;
for increasing the ground is yellow;
for subjugating, on red ground;
for the fierce rite, on black ground.
Pacifying is mostly done at dusk;
increasing is said to be done in the morning;
subjugating at the time of evening;
the fierce rite is done at midnight or midday.
Draw with colors that correspond,
or else flowers will also do.
Thus the hearths should be made.

The substances should be known as follows.
Pacifying is with butter and sesame;
for increasing, yogurt and barley dough;
for subjugating and summoning, utpala flowers;
for the fierce rite, with thorns;

for expelling too, with thorns.
These are common to all:
the purifying torma, scent and ointment,
flowers, lamps, food for the deity,
kindling sticks, sprouts of kuśa grass,
butter and honey, dūrvā grass,
camphor, zhosha, nutmeg and so on,
fruits of various kinds,
and other liquid substances as well,
unbroken rice, wheat and grain,
barley soup and wheat soup,
the five nectars and milk,
welcoming water and water for the feet.
For the fierce rite: earth from the footprint
of the one to be subdued, excrement and urine,
blood and powdered human bone,
poison, mustard seed and salt,
the five heroes and hawk meat.
Other things are the filling ladle and the pouring ladle,
and vessels for the welcoming water and the rest.
Firewood that comes from the tip of the branches
is wanted for the activity of pacifying.
Firewood that comes from the middle of the branches
is wanted for the activity of the fierce rite.
Kindling sticks that come from trees such as the sacrificial tree,
twelve fingers long,
are auspicious for the activity of pacifying;
for increasing they are one cubit;
for subjugating and summoning, as for pacifying;
for the fierce rite, ten fingers.
For pacifying, use the fire of one without protector
or of an ordinary brahmin.
For increasing, perform it with fire
from a family of the kṣatriya or vaiśya caste.
For subjugating and summoning, perform it with fire
from a despised person, or fire found on the road.
For the fierce rite, perform it with fire

from a caṇḍāla, or fire struck from stone.
The handle of the filling ladle and the pouring ladle is a cubit;
at the bottom make a vajra and a jewel.
Above that, the filling ladle is four fingers wide,
its lip shaped like a lotus petal.
The pouring ladle is lotus-shaped, two fingers wide,
its mouth marked with a vajra.
Distinguished in color according to the sequence of activities,
they should be offered in correspondence.
The masters, or the practitioner,

possessing all the characteristics, without lack,
skilled in the activities of the fire offering,
should perform the activities of the fire offering with love.
Here the deities are of three kinds:
the one who receives what is burnt, the one who performs the activity,
and the fire god who is to be worshiped;
their characteristics will be known below.
The hearth should be understood as described.
Then that practitioner,
having first bathed and so forth,
sits well in the fire-offering house
and meditates on the yoga of the deity
that corresponds to the activity.
Then over the vessel of the purifying torma
these secret mantras should be recited:
oṃ rakṣa rakṣa hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ
With this the substances are to be protected.
Then over the welcoming water and the rest
recite their respective secret mantras,
or else recite these:
oṃ āḥ hūṃ
Having imagined that all is pure,
take the fire described above,
and with rakṣa sprinkle it with the purifying torma.
Purify the hearth, put the fire in,
and kindle it with a fan:

oṃ a he ru ka vajra jvala jvala raṃ hūṃ
Then, in order to bind the obstructors,
having recited these mantras,
bind them in the east, south, west and north,
and having bound them, bind them above as well:
oṃ sarvva vighnana hūṃ phaṭ
Recite this mantra of the Victors
that turns everything into emptiness:
oṃ śūnyatā jñāna vajra svabhāva ātmako 'haṃ
Within emptiness, from raṃ and from hūṃ itself,
imagine a crossed vajra,
and emanate light rays from hūṃ
that pacify the māras of beings.
These secret mantras should be recited:
oṃ rakṣa rakṣa hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ
From that, encircle it with a tent of vajras
and surround it with a fence as well.
The vajra ground and the expanse of space;
yaṃ raṃ baṃ laṃ: the four maṇḍalas of the elements;
and the celestial palace arisen
from the maṇḍala of bhūṃ: these should be imagined.
In its center imagine
the hearth arisen from hūṃ.
In it, arisen from raṃ,
is a triangular blazing fire.
In that, imagine a lotus from baṃ.
Through the five manifest awakenings
generate Vajrasattva.
Vajrasattva, transforming completely
in the manner of great passion,
is imagined as the fire god arisen from raṃ.
For pacifying, the fire god is the Bhaga fire;
for increasing, the fire of great power;
for subjugating and summoning, the fire of desire;
for the fierce rite, the killing fire.
He has three faces and six arms;
with the first pair he fully embraces his consort.

His color and hand implements accord with the type of activity;
imagine him blazing accordingly.
Then, with light rays from his heart,
invite the wisdom fire god
and dissolve him into the commitment fire god.
With the four, Gaurī and the others,
summon, insert, bind and bring under control.
Bless his eyes and body.
With light rays from the seed syllable at the heart
urge the protectors of the ten directions,
and receive empowerment.
For pacifying, the fire god has Vairocana,
for increasing, Ratnasambhava,
for subjugating and summoning, Amitābha,
for the fierce rite, Akṣobhya:
imagine these as his crown ornament.
Offer welcoming water, the purifying torma and water for the feet.
Then on the tongue of the fire god
and inside the filling ladle and the pouring ladle
set out the syllable raṃ.
Seven ladlefuls, or three, or one,
should be offered with the fire god's mantra.
Then carefully examine in that fire
the signs of its blazing;
bad signs are to be averted.
Then, having purified all the articles of offering
with the purifying torma,
worship fully with all the offerings.

oṃ āḥ hūṃ rakṣa rakṣa hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ: this is the mantra of the purifying torma. oṃ āḥ vajra rale hūṃ: this is the mantra of the welcoming water. oṃ āḥ niriti hūṃ: this is the mantra of the water for the feet. oṃ āḥ vajra dhuppe hūṃ: of the incense. oṃ āḥ vajra puṣpe hūṃ svāhā: of the flowers. oṃ āḥ vajra āloke hūṃ svāhā: of the lamps. oṃ āḥ vajra ghandhe hūṃ svāhā: of the scent. oṃ akāro mukhaṃ sarvva dharmāṇāṃ ādyanutpannatvāta oṃ āḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā: of the food. oṃ sarva pāpaṃ hana daha hūṃ of the one named so-and-so sarvva pāpaṃ dahana vajrā svāhā: of the sesame. oṃ sarvva

saṃbade svāhā: of the yogurt and barley dough. oṃ vajra yājñāya svāhā: of the kindling sticks. oṃ bodhi vṛkṣāya svāhā: of the wood of the bodhi tree. oṃ vajra puṣṭaye svāhā: of the rice. With oṃ vajra ghasmarīya svāhā offer wheat. oṃ mahā pegaya svāhā: of the barley. With oṃ vajra vijāya svāhā offer grain. oṃ mahā balāya svāhā: of the black gram. oṃ vajra āyuṣe svāhā: of the dūrvā grass. oṃ apratihata vajrāya svāhā: of the kuśa grass. oṃ mahā śādhaye svāhā: of walnuts, camphor, zhosha and nutmeg. Other liquid substances, moreover, should be offered with the deity's mantra.

oṃ vajra ānala mahābhūta jvāla sarvva bhasmi kuru dṛśya ho jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ smaya ho samaya staṃ a'haṃ

At the end, again offer ladlefuls of butter.
Having offered the purifying torma and the water for the feet,
praise with this praise:

Son of the supreme Brahmā, lord of the world,
king of the fire gods, empowered by Ṭakki,
who with supreme wisdom burns away all afflictions:
to the terrifying fire god I bow down.

oṃ sarva tathāgata stuti vajra svabhāva ātmako 'haṃ

Then nectar should be offered: oṃ sarvva tathāgata amṛta svada vajra svabhāva ātmako 'haṃ

Then at the heart of the fire god
imagine the deities of the maṇḍala.
Then, with light rays from his heart,
invite the wisdom maṇḍala,
and with the four, Gaurī and the others,
summon, insert, bind and bring under control.
Then perform the mantras and the protection.
Offer welcoming water and water for the feet.
Bless the eyes and the body,
and receive empowerment:
oṃ sarva tathāgata abhiṣeka vajra svabhāva ātmako 'ho
Then purify the substances
and worship properly with the offerings.
The substances specially taught
should be offered as far as one is able.
In order to accomplish the activities properly,

pacifying, increasing, subjugating and fierce,
attach this to the end of the mantra:

śāntiṃ kuru svāhā
puṣṭi kuru oṃ
baśaṃ kuru hoḥmā
raya phaṭ
To increase the splendor of the deities,
offer ladles filled with butter.
Having offered welcoming water and the purifying torma,
perform these praises.
Then let them taste the nectar;
ask their forbearance and request them to depart.
Gather the samaya deities into the heart.
Then, in order to pacify obstacles,
for the guests, the guardians of the directions and the rest,
bless the offering with this mantra:
oṃ akāro mukhaṃ sarvva dharmāṇāṃ ādyanutpannatvāta oṃ āḥ hūṃ phaṭ
and offer torma to each with their own mantras.
Then to the wisdom fire god
present offerings and make praises.
Have him come and taste the nectar.
Having offered the purifying torma and the scattered libation,
ask his forbearance and request him to depart:
"My own aim and the aim of others
are accomplished; Eater of Oblations (Agni), please depart.
Regarding us with a loving heart,
please come again."
Dissolve the samaya fire god into the blaze.
Dedicate the root of virtue,
and, with the pride of one's own deity,
remain just as before.
Just as grass grows upon a rock
when rain falls from the sky,
so through the blessing of the gurus
even a sophist like me has been moved to explain.
Since my wisdom is not clear

and I am lacking in the meaning of the tantras and so on,
for whatever does not accord with the extensive scriptures
I ask the forbearance of the heirs of the victors.
Whatever virtue I have gained
by explaining this fire offering rite
of the Blessed Hevajra,
by it may all beings without exception
swiftly attain Hevajra.

The Fire Offering Rite of Glorious Hevajra, composed by the master Kṛṣṇa, is complete. It was translated, edited and finalized by the Indian preceptor Gayādhara and the chief editor-translator Gö Lhatsé.

Translator's Notes

• "Fire struck from stone" reads rdo las byung ba'i me for the text's mi ("person"), which makes no sense here. "Zhosha" (zho sha) is an offering substance left untranslated because its identification is uncertain. "The five heroes" (dpa' bo lnga) is rendered literally; it may refer to a set of five substances or meats. "The sacrificial tree" renders mchod sbyin, probably a tree used for Vedic sacrifice, whose exact species is uncertain. The line "the remaining rites should be accomplished in that one" is terse; it seems to assign the hearths for subjugating and summoning to one of the shapes named. The text gives black for summoning and expelling as written.
• "The Bhaga fire," "the fire of great power" (dbang chen me), "the fire of desire" ('dod pa'i me) and "the killing fire" (gsod pa'i me) are the names of the four forms of the fire god for the four activities; the Sanskrit equivalents of the last three are uncertain, so they are translated. "Zhosha" (zho sha) is an offering substance left untranslated, as in the preceding piece. "Of the one named so-and-so" renders 'di zhes bya ba'i inside the sesame mantra, where the name of the beneficiary is inserted.
• "Eater of Oblations" renders □□□□□□, a standard epithet of the fire god Agni (Skt. hutabhuj). The author □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as Kṛṣṇa (Kṛṣṇācārya), the usual Sanskrit form of this name in Hevajra literature.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.